	SELECTION AND RECRUITMENT OF TECHNICAL PERSONNEL	
	Document no: ASMF 6.2 TS	
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1. Purpose

To ensure that all personnel influencing laboratory activities are selected based on defined competence requirements, including education, technical knowledge, and skills, in compliance with ISO/IEC 17025:2017 Clause 6.2.

2. Scope

This procedure applies to the selection of all technical personnel, technical signatories, internal auditors, and nominated representatives at AzureSky.

3. Selection Criteria (Minimum Requirements)

The laboratory shall not recruit personnel who do not meet the following baseline criteria:

Role	Minimum Education	Experience Required
Lab Manager/Supervisor / Technical Signatory	Degree/Diploma in Chemistry	- 3+ years in Coal/Mineral Laboratory - Previous technical signatory appointment highly advantageous.
Analyst	Grade 12 (Math/Science) or Diploma in Chemistry	0-1 year (1 year of practical laboratory experience advantageous)
Internal Auditor	Previous technical signatory appointment for ISO/IEC 17025	Participation in at least 2 audit cycles for accreditation
Technical Assistant (Operators)	Grade 12	Basic literacy and numeracy

Role	Minimum Education	Experience Required
Operations Manager	Advanced Diploma in Chemistry	+5 Years in a similar or higher role in a coal laboratory Previous technical signatory is highly advantageous

4. The Selection Process

4.1 Position Definition

Before recruitment begins, the Director reviews the Job Description (JD) for the vacant post. The JD must explicitly list the technical skills required for the said role.

4.2 Recruitment & Interviewing

- **Internal Database/HR/Director:** Candidates are sourced via internal database, headhunting based on previous experience or external providers.
- **Technical Interview:** Candidates are interviewed by the Director and or Lab Manager/Supervisor/Technical Signatory. The interview must include a "Technical Competency Check".

Management assesses the turnaround time to see if the workload can be a factor, so that more personnel can be recruited to mitigate the rising workload pressure amongst personnel.

4.3 Practical Evaluation (Pre-Appointment)

Where possible, candidates for technical roles should undergo a practical assessment (e.g., weighing a sample, performing Calorific Value) to demonstrate basic manual dexterity and understanding of laboratory safety. Hiring experienced personnel in high roles constitutes them only going over how the organization has been setup as a

walkover activity, given their fundamental experience and expertise as requested on the job description.

4.4 Appointment & Induction

Upon selection, the candidate is issued an appointment letter. Before they are allowed to perform independent work, they must undergo:

1. **QMS Induction:** Training on the Quality Manual and ISO 17025/17034 & 17043.
2. **Safety Induction:** Handling of chemicals and furnace safety.
3. **Supervised Training Period:** As per the Competency Procedure (witnessing and assessment).

5. Authorization

Selection does not equal Authorization. Following the recruitment process, the Lab Manager shall follow the training protocol. Only after successful theoretical and practical assessment will the staff member be issued an Authorization Record (ASFM 6.1) for specific tasks.

5.1. Technical Signatories

The selection, appointment & authorization of technical signatories is done in accordance with the following responsibilities, requirements and further extending to SANAS R03 requirements:

- Be conversant with ISO 17025/ISO 17034/ ISO 14043.
- Have in-depth knowledge of the QMS of the organisation.
- Be able to assess and interpret data.
- Have in-depth knowledge of all SANAS requirements relating to accreditation and compliance.
- Be conversant with SANAS documents R03, R04, TR-25, TR-26, R51, R80.
- Prior technical signatory appointment in a similar accredited facility is highly advantageous and recommended.

- Be conversant with all methods listed in the organization's scope of work/accreditation.
- Successful completion of the theoretical assessment for technical signatories & test methods (Onboarding Lab Supervisors/Managers with prior technical signatory appointment in an accredited laboratory do not need test method witnessing, only the theoretical assessments and running of a PT sample for competency evaluation should suffice.) Technical signatories that have been internally appointed must have initially been declared competent on all test methods and have been given training on the other requirements listed.
- Be able to identify, assess, investigate, and address non-conformances that may arise whilst performing duties, as well as lead, conduct/participate in external/external audits and to open, investigate, and address non-conformances identified during audits
- Have overall responsibility to check, evaluate and clear non-conformances that are raised by personnel under your line of reporting even those that have been cleared by the said personnel.
- Formally accept the responsibilities of being a technical signatory.

Revision

Rev no	Contents Changed	Reason for change	Date
01	No change, addition of operations manager.	Criteria for the position were omitted in the initial revision.	20/04/2026